BRITISH AIRWAYS SUPERSONIC

FASTER. CLOSER. A BRIGHTER TOMORROW.

MACH 2.2

LONDON → NEW YORK
~ 3 HOURS





SLEEK AERODYNAMIC FORM

ADVANCED COMPOSITE STRUCTURE

LOWER EMISSIONS TECHNOLOGY

QUIETER SONIC PROFILE





LENGTH: 88 METRES

KEY SPECIFICATIONS

MAX SPEED	Mach 2.2 (2,430 km/
RANGE	7,400 km (typical)
CAPACITY	276 passengers
CREW	6–8
ENGINES	4 × next-generation supersonic turbofan
ALTITUDE	60,000 – 70,000 ft

FUTURE SERVICE CONCEPT • NOT AN ANNOUNCED BA PRODUCT

H AIRWAYS THE NEXT GENERATION

THE PROPOSITION

THE NEXT CHAPTER OF SPEED

The world is not getting smaller. The time between its most important cities can be.

Time is the rarest luxury. British Airways helped make supersonic passenger travel real. Concorde carried more than 2.5 million passengers supersonically, and a typical London-New York crossing took a little under three and a half hours.

Its retirement in 2003 closed an extraordinary chapter - not the ambition behind it. A new generation would need to make speed repeatable: an aircraft that can be certified, operated reliably, welcomed by communities and justified route by route.

A LEGACY WORTH BUILDING ON

"The ambition is not to recreate Concorde exactly. It is to build a credible next chapter around time saved, an exceptional journey, and uncompromising engineering."

01 TIME BACK

Turn selected transatlantic trips into same-day possibilities, with less time spent in the air and more time at destination.

02 NETWORK DISCIPLINE

Start with routes that fit the first aircraft range. Add Asia only with validated range, payload and regulatory permissions.

03 BRITISH AMBITION

Pair a recognisably British service culture with advanced materials, digital maintenance and a noise-first design programme.

MACH 2.2
ILLUSTRATIVE CRUISE-SPEED TARGET

7,400 KM
BASELINE-RANGE TARGET IN SUPPLIED CONCEPT

3H 30M
CONCORDE-ERA LONDON-NEW YORK BENCHMARK

A PHASED GLOBAL NETWORK

GO FIRST WHERE SPEED CHANGES THE DAY

The concept starts with city pairs inside the illustrated baseline range, then expands as the aircraft and approvals evolve.

PHASE 1 / ATLANTIC

LONDON → NEW YORK

≈ 5,540 km

3h 15m - 3h 45m

Flagship business bridge. The clearest proof point for a new transatlantic premium proposition.

PHASE 1 / GULF

LONDON → DUBAI

≈ 5,497 km

3h 15m - 3h 45m

Finance, trade, energy and luxury travel. Within the nominal 7,400 km concept range.

RANGE-EXTENDED

LONDON → TOKYO

≈ 9,592 km

4h 45m - 5h 30m

A later long-range derivative or technical-stop itinerary; not covered by baseline range.

RANGE-EXTENDED

LONDON → SINGAPORE

≈ 10,881 km

5h 15m - 6h

Strategic Asia gateway. Requires materially more range, payload trade-offs or a stop.

ROUTE ARCHITECTURE

One network. Three horizons.



SYDNEY / connected itinerary first

PLANNING NOTE

Distances are approximate great-circle airport-to-airport figures. Flight-time windows are illustrative concept estimates, not schedules or validated aircraft performance. The Sydney distance is about 17,020 km and sits well outside the supplied 7,400 km baseline-range concept; the initial proposition is a coordinated one-ticket connection, not a nonstop Mach 2.2 promise.

THE AIRCRAFT CONCEPT

A NEW ARROW FOR THE ATLANTIC

A long, high-speed airframe built around sustained supersonic cruise - with every number still to be proven in a real engineering programme.



ILLUSTRATIVE VISUAL / NOT A CERTIFIED OR BUILT AIRCRAFT

MACH 2.2	2,430 KM/H	7,400 KM	88 METRES	276 SEATS	60-70K FT
Target cruise speed	Nominal figure in supplied artwork	Baseline range target	Illustrated overall length	Concept capacity shown in artwork	Illustrative cruise altitude

AERODYNAMIC EFFICIENCY

High-speed planform and inlet design must balance cruise efficiency, stability and low-speed handling.

THERMAL & MATERIALS

Thermal expansion, fatigue, composite/metal interfaces and maintainability are core design drivers.

NOISE-FIRST SYSTEMS

Engine, exhaust and airframe shaping must be evaluated for airport noise and sonic-boom impact.

Specification status: these figures are taken from the supplied visual concept and are not validated performance, final design data, a procurement commitment or an approved aircraft configuration. Claims in the artwork about emissions and sonic profile are objectives to test, not demonstrated outcomes. Actual Mach-to-km/h conversion varies with atmospheric conditions.

THE PASSENGER PROPOSITION

THE JOURNEY IS THE PRODUCT

Make every minute saved feel considered: precise service, a restorative cabin and an exceptional arrival.

01

SIGNATURE SUITE

Privacy for the most important hours of the day.

A private-feeling space, lie-flat rest, individual lighting, tailored dining and quiet zones for focused work.

02

CLUB CABIN

A premium cabin designed around arriving ready.

Direct-aisle access, business-ready connectivity, refined service rituals and a menu paced for a shorter flight.

03

PREMIUM CABIN

More comfort, without losing the sense of occasion.

Generous personal space, well-designed storage, high-quality dining and attentive British hospitality.

THE BRITISH TABLE

Seasonal British ingredients, a concise destination-aware menu, excellent tea and coffee, a serious wine list and equally considered non-alcoholic options. The service should feel more like a private club than a compressed long-haul routine.

THE GROUND EXPERIENCE

Premium check-in, lounge access, priority boarding and baggage handling, a seamless BA app journey and one-ticket connections. Fast Wi-Fi and live collaboration tools are design objectives subject to cabin systems and connectivity performance.

WHAT YOU GAIN

A London departure can become a same-day New York meeting, a full afternoon of negotiations or a dinner reservation that does not require an overnight flight. Exact schedules would depend on route approvals, slot availability, winds and operating performance.

Cabin classes and service concepts are illustrative. Final seat count, cabin mix, onboard systems and premium ground benefits would depend on engineering, economics and actual British Airways product decisions.

THE NON-NEGOTIABLES

FASTER MUST ALSO MEAN SMARTER

Commercial supersonic aviation only returns if speed is matched by safety, community acceptability and a defensible environmental case.

01 SAFETY & CERTIFICATION

A passenger aircraft requires a full safety case, type certification, crew training, dispatch reliability and maintainable systems. A concept render is not evidence of readiness.

02 SONIC BOOM & AIRPORT NOISE

Routes must respect each country's operating rules. NASA's X-59 programme is collecting evidence for quieter supersonic flight; it is a research programme, not a commercial approval.

03 FUEL, CLIMATE & AIR QUALITY

Supersonic flight creates material questions about fuel burn, high-altitude emissions and atmospheric effects. Sustainable aviation fuel may contribute, but it does not by itself prove a lower-impact flight.

04 ROUTES, AIRPORTS & COMMUNITIES

The network needs suitable runway and ground infrastructure, permitted flight corridors, noise-compatible procedures and transparent consultation with affected communities.

REGULATORY SNAPSHOT / OCTOBER 2026 The FAA says two proposed rules are being developed for civil supersonic operation and noise thresholds, with finalisation targeted by mid-2027. ICAO announced tighter aircraft noise standards in March 2026 and said future supersonic aircraft will need to meet noise limits applied to today's subsonic aircraft from 2029. Neither milestone means this concept is certified or cleared for service.

No "zero-emission" or "climate-neutral" claim is made. Environmental performance would need independent, route-specific evidence against a defined baseline.

FROM VISION TO FLIGHT PLAN

PROVE THE AIRCRAFT. THEN OPEN THE WORLD.

A responsible path to service is gated by evidence, not an arbitrary launch date.

01

DEFINE

Concept & business case

Validate target passengers, premium yield, payload-range requirements, aircraft economics and the routes that justify the speed premium.

02

DE-RISK

Technology partnerships

Work through propulsion, aerodynamics, thermal management, materials, maintenance and noise-reduction demonstrators.

03

CERTIFY

Flight test & approvals

Build a full safety case, demonstrate airport noise performance, prove operational reliability and secure national and international approvals.

04

LAUNCH IN STAGES

Premium routes first

Evaluate Atlantic and Gulf service first. Add Tokyo and Singapore only with a suitable long-range derivative. Serve Australia initially through coordinated connections.

THE FUTURE OF FLIGHT IS A PROMISE KEPT THROUGH ENGINEERING.

Not an announced service, a launch commitment or a finished aircraft - but a coherent proposition to test against the realities of range, certification, economics and public confidence.

REFERENCE NOTES

British Airways - “Celebrating Concorde” (historical service, typical London-New York time, passenger and aircraft facts). britishairways.com/content/en/es/information/about-ba/history-and-heritage/celebrating-concorde

Federal Aviation Administration - “Supersonic Flight” (regulatory proposals and timelines; page updated 9 July 2026). faa.gov/supersonic

NASA - “NASA’s X-59 Aircraft Flies Supersonic for First Time” (5 June 2026). nasa.gov/aeronautics/x-59-first-supersonic-flight/

ICAO - “New aircraft will face stricter environmental standards” (27 March 2026). icao.int/news/new-aircraft-will-face-stricter-environmental-standards

IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER

This is an independent speculative concept brochure prepared for discussion. It is not issued by, endorsed by or a representation of British Airways plc and does not announce an actual BA product or route. Aircraft visual, specification values, cabin concepts and flight-time windows are illustrative assumptions only. The supplied design values have not been validated by an aircraft manufacturer or regulator. Distances are approximate great-circle airport distances. Timings, range, capacity, cost, environmental impact, certification and operating rights would require detailed engineering, economic and regulatory validation. No purchase, launch or service date is implied.